

Baby Sleep Training Methods Not Working — Action Checklist

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VERIFY SLEEP SCHEDULE FOUNDATION

- ☐ **Calculate wake windows between naps and compare to age-appropriate ranges (1.75-4 hours depending on whether your baby is 4-14 months old) to see if timing is causing the failure.:** Calculate wake windows between naps and compare to age-appropriate ranges (1.75-4 hours depending on whether your baby is 4-14 months old) to see if timing is causing the failure.
- ☐ **For babies 6-9 months, ensure the first nap starts no later than 2.5 hours after morning wake to prevent overtiredness from sabotaging sleep training efforts.:** For babies 6-9 months, ensure the first nap starts no later than 2.5 hours after morning wake to prevent overtiredness from sabotaging sleep training efforts.
- ☐ **For babies 10-14 months, confirm total awake time before bed is no more than 4 hours of wakefulness between the last nap and bedtime.:** For babies 10-14 months, confirm total awake time before bed is no more than 4 hours of wakefulness between the last nap and bedtime.
- ☐ **Track your baby's sleep for 3 consecutive days to establish whether undertiredness or overtiredness is the actual problem preventing method success.:** Track your baby's sleep for 3 consecutive days to establish whether undertiredness or overtiredness is the actual problem preventing method success.

RULE OUT MEDICAL AND DEVELOPMENTAL BLOCKERS

- ☐ **Check your baby's current age against Wonder Weeks leap timeline to see if a developmental leap (around 4.5, 6.5, 9, or 12 months) is temporarily blocking learning.:** Check your baby's current age against Wonder Weeks leap timeline to see if a developmental leap (around 4.5, 6.5, 9, or 12 months) is temporarily blocking learning.
 - ☐ **Look for signs of reflux such as arching during feeds, excessive spit-up, or screaming when put flat that would make sleep training cruel and ineffective.:** Look for signs of reflux such as arching during feeds, excessive spit-up, or screaming when put flat that would make sleep training cruel and ineffective.
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- ☐ **Watch for food sensitivity indicators including bloody or mucus stools, skin rashes, and general irritability that could be causing nighttime gut discomfort.:** Watch for food sensitivity indicators including bloody or mucus stools, skin rashes, and general irritability that could be causing nighttime gut discomfort.
- ☐ **If your baby shows any signs of pain when lying flat, schedule a pediatric appointment before continuing sleep training to rule out ear infections or reflux.:** If your baby shows any signs of pain when lying flat, schedule a pediatric appointment before continuing sleep training to rule out ear infections or reflux.

MATCH METHOD TO BABY'S TEMPERAMENT

- ☐ **If your baby escalates and cannot de-escalate during check-ins, abandon graduated extinction and switch to Pick Up Put Down or Bedtime Fading to reduce distress.:** If your baby escalates and cannot de-escalate during check-ins, abandon graduated extinction and switch to Pick Up Put Down or Bedtime Fading to reduce distress.
- ☐ **Choose the Chair Method if your baby only falls asleep with parental presence and cannot self-soothe independently, as this matches their temperament.:** Choose the Chair Method if your baby only falls asleep with parental presence and cannot self-soothe independently, as this matches their temperament.
- ☐ **Resume sleep training only after confirming the schedule is age-appropriate, medical issues are ruled out, and your baby is not in an active developmental leap.:** Resume sleep training only after confirming the schedule is age-appropriate, medical issues are ruled out, and your baby is not in an active developmental leap.
- ☐ **Accept that a method mismatch is not failure—it's information indicating you need to try a different approach rather than repeating one that causes escalation.:** Accept that a method mismatch is not failure—it's information indicating you need to try a different approach rather than repeating one that causes escalation.